

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Stone Age chronological-climatic spine

PLEISTOCENE

HOLOCENE

Lower Palaeolithic	-> Middle Palaeolithic	-> Upper Palaeolithic	-> Mesolithic
handaxe/cleaver	flakes/prepared cores	blades/bone/art	microliths
mobile landscapes	flexible reduction	wider symbolism	diverse niches
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Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Stone is a behavioural archive

RAW-MATERIAL NODULE -> CORE REDUCTION -> FLAKE/BLADE -> TOOL USE -> DISCARD

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source distance   skill/planning   edge damage   activity area
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ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT -> BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Lithic systems compared

LOWER	MIDDLE	UPPER	MESOLITHIC
bifaces, cleavers	flake tools	blades, burins	geometric microliths
large cutting tools	prepared-core planning	bone/ornament growth	hafted composites
quartzite common	raw-material economy	symbolic evidence	bow/sickle/barb uses
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Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.			

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Indian site map: region, site, significance

NORTH-WEST: Soan valley -> river-terrace lithics and sequence debates

NORTH: Belan valley -> long prehistoric sequence toward food production

CENTRAL: Bhimbetka -> shelters/rock art | Adamgarh -> Mesolithic evidence

WEST: Bagor -> Mesolithic settlement, subsistence and domestication debate

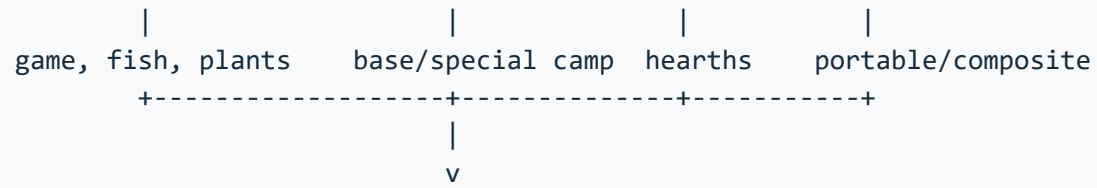
GANGA PLAIN: Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha, Damdama -> burials and sedentism

SOUTH: Attirampakkam -> early Acheulian and Middle Palaeolithic chronology

DECCAN: Hunsgi-Baichbal -> quarry, factory and landscape organisation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Mobility-subsistence-social loop

SEASONAL RESOURCES -> MOVEMENT SCHEDULE -> CAMP TYPE -> TOOL KIT -> SHARING NETWORK



Repeated occupation and storage may increase without full farming or permanent villages.
Burials show treatment of persons; rank needs patterned unequal evidence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Rock art and symbolic life: inference ladder

PIGMENT/ENGRAVING + SUPERIMPOSITION + MOTIF + SHELTER CONTEXT

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secure: image, technique, relative sequence and demonstrated association

probable: hunting, dance, group action, animals and changing style

uncertain: exact myth, deity, artist identity or direct ritual meaning

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VERDICT: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Mesolithic transition: adaptation, not revolution

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES

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small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools

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seasonal mobility

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repeated/semi-sedentary camps

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selective plant/animal management -> uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Limits and current research

PROBLEM: sparse fossils + disturbed sites + broad tool labels + uncertain associations

FALSE SHORTCUTS: one tool = one people | innovation = migration | burial = hierarchy

RESPONSE: date contexts, reconstruct reduction sequence, compare regions, state confidence

Refined chronometry and landscape study can revise early dates.

VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Stone Age answer architecture

10 MARKS: define phase -> diagnostic technology -> two sites -> subsistence -> caution

15 MARKS: chronology -> lithic comparison -> ecology/mobility -> symbolic evidence -> limits

20 MARKS: geological frame -> methods -> four-stage technology -> regional site map
-> economy/social life -> Mesolithic transition -> historiographical verdict

MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism.

CLOSE: technology records adaptive choices, not a uniform evolutionary ladder.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Start with macro-phase, then regional sequence, dated stratum and assemblage.
2. Read cores, flakes, debitage, wear and raw material before inferring behaviour.
3. Separate lithic technology from hominin taxonomy, language and group identity.

VERDICT: Broad chronology guides comparison; site context controls the claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Acheulian is a technology, Levallois a method and microlith a tool element.
2. Bhimbetka spans many periods; rock-art meaning and dates remain indirect.
3. Mesolithic domestication and sedentariness must be established site by site.

VERDICT: Transition means changing combinations, overlap and regional coexistence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Use the 2019 Denisovan PYQ to separate population, place and geological period.
 2. Compare phases through tools, ecology, mobility, habitation, art and burials.
 3. Write claim -> site/assemblage -> significance -> date/context limit -> verdict.
- VERDICT: Indian prehistory is regionally varied history reconstructed without texts.